PlanetCompute: A Verifiable AI Grid from Idle Browsers and Desktops

Design, Early Measurements, and a Million-Device Simulation

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Abstract

PlanetCompute is a volunteer-computing system that aims to serve AI inference from idle browsers and desktops; we report what is built, measured and only simulated. Built: one job format (**WorkPacks**) whose integer kernels give bit-identical results as WebAssembly in a browser and as native code in a Tauri 2 desktop program, which also runs whole chat and image prompts in sandboxed llama.cpp and stable-diffusion.cpp engines; commit-then-random-audit leases; and a **SherpaHub** that cuts matrix multiplies into packs checked by Freivalds' method, which finished two split jobs of up to 262,144 units with no wrong answer on one operator server, though at only 1.5% of the kernel's speed, limited by round trips. Measured offline on three NVIDIA GPUs, not yet in the program: diffusion and LLM audits costing 3.3–8.9% of the work. Analysed and simulated: we show that over home links such packs are bounded by upload bandwidth, argue for cutting the work rather than the model and size packs by a square-root law; derive the exact collusion probability of quorum validation, under which a naive "first three matching answers" rule accepts 5.8% wrong packs at 20% colluders (6.1% in simulation); show that spare replicas, network-distinct quorums and retroactive invalidation remove them; and simulate the orchestrator at a million devices, where, with 2% ordinary cheaters, in the final designs no wrong answer reached a consumer uncorrected, and a low-cost design cut the running cost about elevenfold at the price of latency. No volunteer outside the operator's servers has yet taken part.

Keywords: volunteer computing, compute grid, WorkPacks, AI inference, competitive dispatch, network-distinct quorum, Freivalds' check, audits, WebAssembly, Tauri, llama.cpp, sabotage tolerance

Executive Summary

Every night, millions of PCs and laptops sit idle for hours, mine and yours included. So why not lend that spare power to each other? With PlanetCompute, your idle machine shares its compute by helping run jobs for others, and you collect PlanetComp points in return. When you need serious power yourself, you can draw compute from the community pool, free for now within a daily limit. Your points are kept in your PlanetCompute account, your lifetime contributions are tracked separately for bragging rights, and you can transfer points to your own wallet as the PlanetComp token on the Solana blockchain. To keep everyone's balances honest, PlanetCompute can record a fingerprint of all balances on the blockchain (built, not yet run), so anyone can check their own. Imagine one day rendering a full 100-minute movie on the world's spare computers while you sleep (long video is designed, not yet built): no render farm, no huge cloud bill, just a community helping each other. It might take a few weeks to finish, but you pay no cloud bill: you would spend the points you collected by sharing your idle time, and your real costs are the electricity and wear of your own computer while it shares, and related expenses.

Of course, this only works if enough compute is contributed to the community pool. As of this paper's release the pool is empty, so we're seeding it with our own compute to get things started, though even that may not be enough at first. As more members join and the network becomes self-sufficient, we'll gradually reduce our share and may eventually phase it out completely.

Disclaimer

PlanetComp is a ledger of contributions only and may have no monetary value. All PlanetComp is disbursed from the official PlanetCompute wallet. Before transferring any PlanetComp to an external crypto wallet, check the laws in your country and local area. If holding cryptocurrency is not permitted where you live, do not make the transfer, whether or not PlanetComp has any value. If PlanetComp ever gains value, that value can fall or be lost entirely at any time. By transferring PlanetComp, you acknowledge and accept these risks. Use your own discretion; you are responsible for complying with the laws that apply to you.

1 Introduction

Harvesting idle cycles is older than the web: Xerox PARC's "worm" programs spread one computation across idle workstations at night in 1982 (Shoch and Hupp, 1982), Condor scheduled jobs onto idle workstations from 1988 (Litzkow et al., 1988), and in 1989 volunteers' computers factored large numbers from pieces sent by email (Lenstra and Manasse, 1990). BOINC (Anderson, 2004, 2020) later showed that millions of volunteers will donate compute, Folding@home (Beberg et al., 2009; Zimmerman et al., 2021) reached exascale in 2020, and commercial successors (Golem (Golem Factory, 2016), Salad (Salad Technologies, 2026)) added payment. Generative AI adds new demand: image, video and chat inference whose units, cut the right way, are largely independent.

Four problems persist. (1) **The host dilemma:** native clients run overnight and reach the GPU but must be built, signed and trusted per platform; browser clients need no install but are throttled and die with the tab. (2) **Code safety:** volunteers must trust each project's native binaries. (3) **Consent:** in-browser mining was overwhelmingly covert (Eskandari et al., 2018; Konoth et al., 2018). (4) **Verification and fair credit:** unchecked, a few percent of cheaters poison a result set (Sarmenta, 2002). PlanetCompute answers with four principles: the **WorkPack is the portable unit** (a signed job with fixed inputs whose result is the same bytes on every host); **two hosts, one format**; **competition with consolation** (the first validated finisher receives the largest credit, other matching finishers consolation credit); and **validation as protocol** (quorum, audits, strikes and credit are specified, not left to client goodwill).

1.1 Contributions

(1) A **two-host design**: browser and desktop compute the same packs with bit-identical results (fixed WebAssembly and native kernels, one binary pack format, leases with commit-and-audit), and the desktop also runs whole AI prompts; a byte ABI for third-party modules is specified, not built (Section 2). (2) **Inference WorkPacks**: why not to split models, a square-root law for pack size, audits with escrow (Section 3). (3) **QuickMode/BatchMode** and **SherpaHub**, with measured kernels, a fault simulator, a live broker and two live split jobs (Section 4). (4) **Offline GPU measurements** of throughput, cross-GPU reproducibility and audit cost (Section 5). (5) **Validation and credit**: the exact quorum-race probability, strikes with retroactive invalidation, commit-then-random-audit (Section 6). (6) **Competitive dispatch**

with a closed-form attack analysis and a hybrid rule that is zero-error in simulation (Section 7). (7) An **orchestrator simulated at a million devices** (Section 8). (8) A threat model and privacy tiers (Section 9), and `planetCompute`, one program that contributes a machine and serves models on it, with first measurements and tests (Section 10).
All code, scripts, raw results and test logs are in the repository (https://github.com/syncaissa/planetCompute.cpp).

2 The PlanetCompute Architecture

Figure 1 shows the system as built: one job format, two hosts. Table 17 separates what runs today from what is specified.

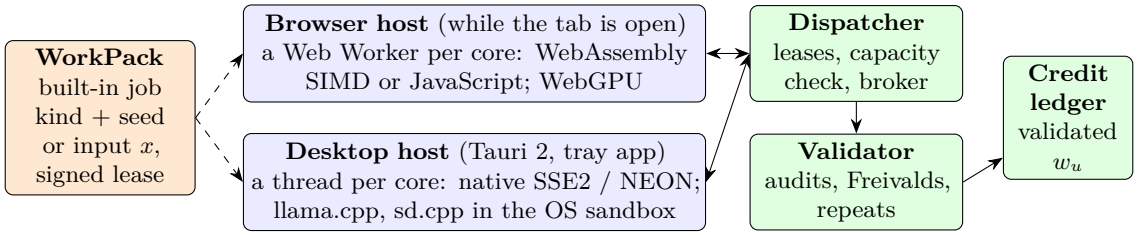


Figure 1: PlanetCompute as built. Both hosts compute the same WorkPack kinds with bit-identical results (WebAssembly or JavaScript in the browser, native kernels on the desktop) and report to one dispatcher, validator and credit ledger. The page comes from one Cloudflare Worker; the program ships as builds signed with the project's Ed25519 key (not yet code-signed by the operating systems) for Windows, macOS and Linux (sd.cpp: stable-diffusion.cpp). Third-party modules fetched by hash, the byte ABI and their `/v1/claim` protocol are specified, not built (Table 17).

Specified: the general WorkPack.

Definition 2.1 (WorkPack)**.** A WorkPack is a tuple $U = (id, h_M, x, \pi, \mathcal{K}, w, t_{\mathrm{dl}})$ where $h_M = \mathrm{SHA256}(M)$ identifies module M, x is the input byte string, $\pi \in \{\mathtt{cpu}, \mathtt{gpu}, \mathtt{nn}\}$ the tier, $\mathcal{K}$ the minimum host capabilities, w the benchmark-normalised cost used for credit, and t_{dl} the deadline.

Modules are fetched by hash and checked against a signed manifest, so a tampered CDN can deny service but never substitute code. A module **imports nothing** and exports one memory and three functions, `pc_alloc`(n), `pc_run`(p, n) and `pc_output`$()$; the result is $r = \mathrm{SHA256}(M(x))$, and with no imports a module has no clock, randomness, I/O or network. A module is *admissible* if it validates under WebAssembly 2.0 (W3C WebAssembly Working Group, 2025) with no threads, no relaxed-SIMD and no non-canonical NaN bits in its output; admissible modules give the same bytes in every engine.

Built today. Instead of this general module, the job kinds are fixed (Table 17) and bit-identical on both hosts, so a Chrome tab and the program on any system form *one* validation pool.

GPU. WebGPU (W3C GPU for the Web Working Group, 2025) runs the browser's GPU WorkPacks; wgpu (gfx-rs contributors, 2026) would run the same shaders natively (planned). The desktop reaches the GPU today through its sandboxed AI engines, given only a model name and inputs. **No tier ever executes native code supplied by a job.**

Politeness. Today a device computes only with recorded consent, on the cores its owner grants and under a CPU cap γ: after each pack of length t a worker rests $t(1-\gamma)/\gamma$, so PlanetCompute's share of a granted core is at most γ, and the program's credit WorkPacks pause while it answers a chat job or makes a picture. Planned are user idle, AC power, allowed hours, a thermal limit and other processes' load below 0.20, which a browser observes only in part (Section 9.1).

3 Designing WorkPacks for Inference

The central design question is how to cut an inference job (image, music, video, chat, code) into WorkPacks so that the answer arrives with minimum wait.

3.1 Cut the Work, Not the Model

Over the internet the hop between two machines costs far more than the arithmetic it carries. With illustrative values (one-way latency 20 ms, residential upload 2.5 MB/s, an RTX 4090-class GPU), an 8B LLM at 4-bit (32 layers) decodes a token in ≈5 ms on one machine (Table 1).

Table 1: Splitting one LLM across volunteer machines (illustrative).

Split	**Time per token**	**vs. one machine**
Whole model on one machine	≈5 ms	1×
One layer per machine (pipeline)	32×20 ms $= 640$ ms	≈ 130× slower
Every matmul over k machines (tensor parallel)	$2 \times 32 \times 40$ ms $= 2.56$ s	≈ 500× slower

Diffusion is no different: handing an SDXL latent (131 KB) on after each denoising step costs ≈72 ms against a 0.1–0.3 s step (Table 3), and gains nothing, because step $k{+}1$ needs step k. A job is therefore split only along an axis that is **parallel** and **coarse** (compute per hop at least nine times the hop's cost): requests, seeds, images, tiles, keyframe-anchored video chunks, audio segments, code candidates and test files. Steps, tokens and layers are never split across machines in QuickMode; a model that fits no single volunteer is served as a fixed pipeline lane in the style of Petals (Borzunov et al., 2023). An *inference WorkPack* is thus a run of b independent units of one job, for one *lane* (model hash, quantisation, runtime) that the device already holds in memory.

Frame-parallel video. Video looks sequential but need not be. A plan stage computes a motion plan $m = \Phi(I_0; s)$ with a shared seed s, in which each region moves by closed-form kinematics, $\mathbf{p}_r(t) = \mathbf{p}_r + \mathbf{v}_r t + \frac{1}{2}\mathbf{a}_r t^2$; keyframes $K_j = G_\theta(I_0, m, j\Delta; s)$ are then mutually independent, and in-between frames depend only on their two neighbouring keyframes (Huang et al., 2022). In practice a pack is a keyframe-anchored chunk in the model's native window (16–81 frames, 4–8 overlapping), in at most three stages: a small plan, one wide parallel stage, and a merge (Figure 2).

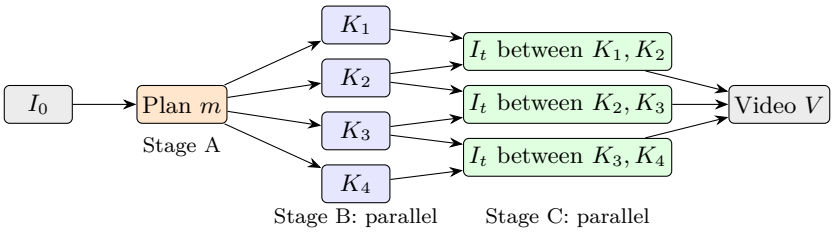


Figure 2: Frame-parallel image-to-video (designed, not yet built). Stage A runs once; Stages B and C fan out to as many idle machines as there are frames. Each box is one or more WorkPacks.

3.2 How Big Should a Pack Be?

Cut a stage of W units into packs of b, pulled by P devices, each pack paying overhead T_o, with t per unit and a tail proportional to pack length:

$$T(b) \;\approx\; \frac{W\,T_o}{P\,b} \;+\; \frac{W\,t}{P} \;+\; \kappa\,b\,t. \tag{1}$$

Proposition 3.1 (Square-root law)**.** *Equation (1) is minimised at* $b^\star = \sqrt{W\,T_o/(P\,\kappa\,t)}$*, i.e. a pack time* $\tau^\star = \sqrt{T_o\,T_{ideal}/\kappa}$*, giving* $T^\star = T_{ideal} + 2\sqrt{\kappa\,T_o\,T_{ideal}}$ *with* $T_{ideal} = Wt/P$*.*

The optimum is flat ($2b^\star$ or $b^\star/2$ raise the overhead term by a quarter). A pull-based simulator (200 devices, log-normal speeds $\sigma = 0.5$, $W \in \{4{,}000, 40{,}000\}$, $T_o \in \{0.5, 2\}$, optional churn $1/600\ \mathrm{s}^{-1}$, 8 or 14 pack sizes, 10 seeds each) confirmed it: **(i)** with end-game hedging (Dean and Ghemawat, 2004) the fitted overhead term matches the prediction within 0.94–1.19×; **(ii)** with hedging, ten times more work grows $\hat{b}^\star$ by 2.4–3.2× ($\sqrt{10} = 3.16$) and four times the overhead by 1.8–2.2× ($\sqrt{4} = 2$); **(iii)** hedging halves the tail coefficient (2.3–3.8 to 0.9–1.8) for 3–22% extra executions; **(iv)** one unit per pack is up to 2.7× slower; **(v)** speed-matched packs with hedging were fastest in all eight settings (8–26% faster without churn, 2–8% with churn). The dispatcher therefore sizes packs by *time*, per device,

$$\tau_d = \mathrm{clamp}\Big(\sqrt{T_o T_{\mathrm{ideal}}/\kappa},\;\; 9\,T_o,\;\; \min\left(0.05/\lambda_d,\ \mathrm{SLO}\right)\Big), \qquad b_d = \max\left(1, \lfloor \tau_d/t_d \rfloor\right), \tag{2}$$

where $9T_o$ keeps efficiency at least 90% and $0.05/\lambda_d$ keeps the chance that device d stays until the pack ends at least 95%. Packs are designed to take ten seconds to five minutes (the live split jobs of Section 4, limited by message size, used far smaller ones).

3.3 Verification at a Few Percent

Replication is affordable for small CPU packs but not for GPU inference, which is to be checked by audit. Both audits below are specified and measured offline (Section 5); neither is in the program yet, which today repeats a share of whole prompts on a second computer instead (Table 17). **Diffusion trace audit:** the initial noise comes from the pack seed by a deterministic CPU generator; the worker commits the Merkle root of its latents, and an audit recomputes one random step (x_k, x_{k-1}) within a tolerance calibrated across GPU types. It costs one step in S and catches a worker that faked a fraction g of steps with probability g. **Teacher-forced LLM audit:** sampling is seeded, $y_i = \arg\max_v (z_{i,v}/T + G_{i,v})$ with Gumbel noise from the pack seed, so the validator checks an answer in one parallel prefill, tolerating differences only where the top two choices are within a calibrated margin.

Proposition 3.2 (Escrow rule)**.** *Hold each worker's last* H *pack credits* R *in escrow, forfeited on a failed audit. If audits occur at rate* a *and detect a fake with probability* p_d*, and skipping a pack saves at most* $c \le R$*, cheating is unprofitable whenever* $a \ge 1/(p_d(1+H))$*.*

Proof. A faked pack earns $(1 - ap_d)R - ap_dHR$ in expectation against $R - c$ for an honest one; cheating does not pay iff $ap_d(1+H)R \ge c$, which holds for all $c \le R$ when $ap_d(1+H) \ge 1$. □

With $H = 49$, an audit rate of 2% deters whole-output fakes and 4% deters fakes of half the steps. Weights are the largest fixed cost (an 8B LLM at 4-bit takes ≈6.5 minutes at 12.5 MB/s): a device joins one lane per session and caches weights by hash.

4 QuickMode, BatchMode and SherpaHub

Every job declares *when* it must finish and *how* it can be cut. The **QuickMode** queue serves a waiting person in seconds; the **BatchMode** queue serves jobs that can wait hours or days (science, long videos). **WholeMode** sends a job uncut to one program (a WorkPack of one unit); **Split** cuts it into many WorkPacks. One pipeline (job → queue → units → WorkPacks → devices) serves all four combinations; QuickMode is served first and BatchMode fills every gap. A browser tab or the program *does* the work; the same program started as a *SherpaHub organises* it.

SherpaHub. Section 3 argued against splitting models because a person waits for every hop; in BatchMode nobody waits, so a SherpaHub can keep hundreds of units in flight and only the *total* maths and bytes count. A SherpaHub holds a model's weights and runs its flow step by step, but cuts each large matrix multiply into *maths packs* ("multiply this block by that block") that browsers compute in their WebAssembly sandbox with no model installed. Blocks use int8 inputs and exact 32-bit sums, so every device returns bit-identical results. A product $C = AB$ is checked with Freivalds' method (Freivalds, 1977): test $A(Br) = Cr$ for a random r in $O(n^2)$ instead of $O(n^3)$. With the entries of r drawn uniformly from a set S of integers and exact integer arithmetic, a wrong C passes one test with probability at most $1/|S|$ (Schwartz–Zippel); we use $S = [-2^{15}, 2^{15})$ and 64-bit sums, so 2^{-16} per round, and the SherpaHub checks *every* pack with no replicas. It keeps the small parts (normalisation, softmax) itself; attention is the open problem. A SherpaHub needs memory, disk, uptime, bandwidth and trust, not a GPU; running one is opt-in.

What is built. Three of four stages are built and tested; the fourth, real model work cut into maths packs, is not. (1) **Kernels that agree everywhere**: the int8 multiply in the program (SSE2 or NEON), as a 655-byte WebAssembly SIMD module and in plain JavaScript is bit-identical on fixed test vectors in each of the five builds (`-workpack-check`); per core on one AMD EPYC server the program does 57.9, the WebAssembly SIMD module (run in Node.js) 24.7 and plain JavaScript 2.05 billion operations a second; two Freivalds rounds let a wrong result pass with probability at most $(2^{-16})^2 = 2^{-32}$. (2) **The SherpaHub**, a pure state machine that cuts a job, sizes packs, checks every result, strikes and bans liars, checkpoints and assembles; with up to 2,000 slow, leaving, lying or garbled-message simulated devices it gave an exact result in every scenario, at **1.09 times the ideal time** with 0.1% of the work done twice when each device had ample work (about 2× with little work per device, and 1.0–2.7× under liars, departures and hub crashes). (3) **The website's broker**: the SherpaHub and every device keep one outbound WebSocket to a Cloudflare Durable Object that relays binary messages unread (1 MiB a message, 2,000 devices a SherpaHub). End to end, three browser-code devices and three programs computed a 4,096-unit job, liars were banned after three strikes, and a SherpaHub killed in a 16,384-unit job continued after a restart with the 4,476 units already done.

Bytes per operation: what limits Split. Hiding latency removes waiting, not bytes. A unit $C_{ij} = A_i B_j$ with $T \times T$ tiles and inner dimension K costs $2T^2K$ operations and returns $4T^2$ bytes of exact 32-bit sums, plus up to $2TK$ bytes of int8 inputs when neither block is cached. The results alone carry one byte per $K/2$ operations, so a device with upload $B_\uparrow$ bytes a second, and a SherpaHub with download $B_\downarrow$, can sustain at most

$$R_{\text{device}} \le \tfrac{K}{2}\, B_\uparrow, \qquad R_{\text{job}} \le \tfrac{K}{2}\, B_\downarrow \tag{3}$$

operations a second. With $K = 4{,}096$, a browser core at 25 billion operations a second would upload 12 MB/s, but a 2.5 MB/s home upload allows 5.1 billion per *device*, a fifth of one core

however many cores it has; and each Gbit/s of the SherpaHub's link caps a job at 256 billion operations a second, about four of the program's EPYC cores. So spreading a model's matrix multiplies over home connections (stage 4) is bandwidth-bound by Equation (3), which is why stage 4 is not built. Split maths packs suit jobs with a large inner dimension or a small output, and devices on fast links; exact int32 results cannot be shrunk without giving up the exact check.

Live split jobs (31 October 2026). Two matrix jobs ran on four program copies of four cores each on the operator's server (Table 2). The result ($4MN$ bytes, 16 GiB for job 2) stays on the SherpaHub's disk until the final check passes, so that disk's free space limits a job's size.

Why the live jobs were slow. The second job reached 13.7 billion operations a second on 16 cores, about 1.5% of the 926 billion that the kernel's measured speed allows (the 42 min 44 s include about 30 s before the first device joined). The protocol is the cause. A result must fit in one broker message (1 MiB), so a pack holds at most 15 units of 128×128 (10.8 on average), about 9 ms of work on four cores; each device has one pack in flight; and every message, including the 512 KiB input blocks, crosses the Cloudflare broker although the SherpaHub and the devices share one server. From the job's totals each device finished a pack every $4 \times 2{,}564/24{,}359 = 0.42$ s and spent about 6.2 ms of it computing, so it was busy 1.5% of the time, as the efficiency bound of Equation (2), $6.2/(6.2 + 415) \approx 1.5\%$, predicts for packs far below its $9T_o$ floor (inferred from the counters and the code). The fix, several packs in flight per device and reuse of the input blocks a device holds, is now built and tested in the SherpaHub simulator (8.9× faster on the live job's shape); a live rerun is pending. Equation (3) sets the limit that remains (four cores would need about 113 MB/s of results per device). The live jobs show correctness, not speed.

Table 2: Split matrix jobs on the live servers, 31 October 2026. Job 1's final pack count was not logged: 79 had been sent by 2,493 of its 4,096 units.

	Job 1	**Job 2**
Product ($M \times K \times N$), tile	4096^3, 64×64	$65{,}536 \times 4{,}096 \times 65{,}536$, 128×128
Units / operations	4,096 / 137 billion	262,144 / 35,184 billion
Packs	≥ 79	24,359 (33 re-sent after a timeout)
Time	about 15–20 s	42 min 44 s (13.7 billion operations/s)
Share of the kernel's speed (16 cores)	about 1%	1.5%
Wrong answers / strikes / final check	0 / 0 / passed	0 / 0 / passed

In-house SherpaHubs. The operator's own SherpaHubs also run batches of whole prompts (WholeMode), with 10% repeated on another computer with the same seed, and two switches: *SupplySimulation* (also contribute) and *DemandSimulation* (also send low-priority test jobs). In an eight-hour side-by-side run on 30 October 2026 against five dedicated load scripts on the same server (Table 14), its jobs were answered almost as often and as fast (a longer tail: they are low priority); the scripts were then retired. Without a GPU pictures are slow: an earlier 512×512 Z-Image Turbo picture took 1,037 s on about nine of its CPU cores.

5 GPU Measurements

We ran the benchmarks on three RunPod GPUs that stand in for volunteer classes: an RTX 3090 (older gaming desktop), an RTX 4090 (current gaming desktop) and an A100 80GB (server), with the same script on each (PyTorch 2.4.1, CUDA 12.4, diffusers 0.32.2, transformers 4.46.3, vLLM 0.6.3); every GPU then audited the other two GPUs' outputs.

Table 3: Measured time per work unit (B1). LLM throughput uses vLLM with 4-bit AWQ models and 512 output tokens per request; 32B does not fit in 24 GB. LTX-Video on the 24 GB cards ran with CPU offload.

Measurement	RTX 3090	RTX 4090	A100 80GB
SDXL 1024^2, 30 steps: s/image (batch 1)	9.37	3.74	3.24
SDXL: s/image (batch 4)	9.04	3.64	2.92
SDXL: s/denoising step	0.312	0.125	0.108
LLM 7B AWQ: tokens/s, batch 1	122	146	155
LLM 7B AWQ: tokens/s, batch 32	2216	3183	3159
LLM 14B AWQ: tokens/s, batch 1	70	83	98
LLM 14B AWQ: tokens/s, batch 32	1228	1900	2100
LLM 32B AWQ: tokens/s, batch 1	–	–	55
LLM 32B AWQ: tokens/s, batch 32	–	–	1278
MusicGen small: s per 10 s audio (batch 1)	4.32	10.10	10.52
MusicGen medium: s per 10 s audio (batch 1)	8.19	20.97	19.55
MusicGen medium: s per 10 s audio (batch 4)	2.39	5.05	4.97
LTX-Video: s per 49-frame 704×480 chunk	22.0	18.6	6.1
Load SDXL to GPU (s)	1.37	2.23	2.46

Throughput (B1). An SDXL image takes 3.7 s on the 4090 and 9.4 s on the 3090. A 7B model decodes 122–155 tokens per second for one request (6.5–8 ms per token, close to the 5 ms assumed in Table 1) and 2,200–3,200 at batch 32, which is why batch chat suits volunteers. MusicGen ran faster on the 3090 pod because its generation loop is bound by the host CPU.

Table 4: SDXL across GPU types (4 prompts, fixed seeds, CPU-generated initial noise). The last column is the largest relative error when one GPU recomputes a single denoising step of another GPU's trace.

GPU pair	Bit-identical	Min SSIM	Max mean $\lvert\Delta\rvert$ (0–255)	Max one-step audit error
RTX 3090 vs RTX 4090	0/4	0.9876	0.96	0.00052
RTX 3090 vs A100 80GB	0/4	0.9890	0.95	0.00052
RTX 4090 vs A100 80GB	0/4	0.9860	1.11	0.00053

Table 5: Cost of one audit (B7). Diffusion: recomputing one denoising step, as a fraction of generating the image. LLM: one teacher-forced pass (fp16) over a 256-token answer, as a fraction of vLLM decoding the same number of tokens at batch 1 (4-bit AWQ, Table 3); an fp16 decode would make the fraction smaller.

GPU	Diffusion audit (s)	of one image	LLM audit (s)	of decoding the answer
RTX 3090	0.313	3.3%	0.164	7.9%
RTX 4090	0.158	4.2%	0.154	8.8%
A100 80GB	0.143	4.4%	0.148	8.9%

Reproducibility (B4, B5). The same seeded SDXL job rerun on the same GPU gave a byte-identical image on all three GPUs. Across types no image was bit-identical, but all matched at SSIM 0.986–0.998 with a mean pixel difference of at most 1.1 of 255 (Table 4). Whole trajectories drift about 1% by the last step, but a *single* step recomputed from the worker's own latent agrees within 5.3×10^{-4} on every pair, so the trace audit would use a tolerance of 10^{-3}. Teacher-forced audits of seeded Qwen2.5-7B sampling (fp16, temperature 0.8, 16 answers of 256 tokens, 4,096 tokens per pair) reproduced 99.88–99.95% of tokens across GPU types and 99.90–99.95% on the same type (Table 6); every disagreement on every pair occurred where the two best choices were within 0.035. The audit would therefore excuse only positions with margin below $\delta = 0.05$; fewer than 2% of positions have a margin below 0.1.

Audit cost (B7). Measured offline in PyTorch and vLLM, auditing one diffusion step costs 3.3–4.4% of making the image, and auditing a whole LLM answer 7.9–8.9% of decoding it (Table 5). At the 2–4% audit rates of Proposition 3.2, verification would add about 0.1–0.4% to the grid's cost, against 400% for five-fold replication; this holds only once the audits run in llama.cpp and stable-diffusion.cpp with tolerances re-measured there.

What carries over to volunteer machines. The RTX 3090 and 4090 are the same GeForce consumer cards volunteers own. Table 6 states, per measurement, what transfers. Volunteers run llama.cpp, stable-diffusion.cpp or WebGPU, not PyTorch, so each lane's tolerances are re-measured in its runtime before it opens; uncalibrated device classes run with full replication.

Table 6: Top: teacher-forced audits of seeded LLM sampling (Qwen2.5-7B-Instruct, fp16, temperature 0.8, 16 answers of 256 tokens, 4,096 tokens per pair): tokens that disagree, and in brackets the largest margin between the two best seeded scores at any disagreement. Bottom: how each GPU measurement carries over to volunteer laptops, desktops and servers.

Generated on ↓ audited on →	**RTX 3090**	**RTX 4090**	**A100 80GB**
RTX 3090	0.10% (0.035)	0.05% (0.010)	0.07% (0.021)
RTX 4090	0.07% (0.029)	0.05% (0.005)	0.05% (0.005)
A100 80GB	0.12% (0.035)	0.12% (0.030)	0.10% (0.030)

Measurement	**Carries over?**	**Why, and what is still needed**
Same-GPU bit-identical results (B4)	Directly	Decided by architecture, kernels and versions; same for a home card with the same stack
Cross-GPU tolerances (B4, B5)	Directly, for these architectures	Re-measure for AMD, Intel, Apple and other NVIDIA generations, and in each lane's runtime
Audit cost as a fraction of work (B7)	Directly	Audit and work slow down together on a slower machine
Seconds per image, token, chunk (B1)	As a scale	Laptops, politeness caps and heat lower it; each device is measured on joining
Speed spread between devices	Supports the model	Measured 2.5–2.9× SDXL gap, consistent with a wide spread such as the simulated $\sigma = 0.5$
Download, network, churn, electricity, owner's use	No	Data-centre links; not measured; the protocol does not depend on these numbers

6 Validation and Credit

PlanetCompute credits only *validated* work and *verified* capacity and combines mechanisms from the sabotage-tolerance literature (Sarmenta, 2002; Anderson, 2020).

Quorum and the collusion race. A unit is issued to distinct random devices until some result hash has q matching votes. If a fraction f of devices always returns the same wrong hash, acceptance is a race to q votes.

Proposition 6.1 (Collusion race)**.** *Under uniform random assignment and negligible honest error, the colluders' hash is accepted with probability*

$$P_{wrong}(f, q) = \sum_{k=0}^{q-1} \binom{q-1+k}{k} f^q (1-f)^k. \tag{4}$$

Proof. The colluders win iff their q-th vote arrives while honest votes number $k \le q-1$, which by the negative binomial distribution has probability $\binom{q-1+k}{k} f^q (1-f)^k$; sum over k. □

For $q = 2$ this is $f^2(3-2f)$, not the often quoted f^2: at $f = 0.2$, 10.4% rather than 4%. Quorum must therefore be paired with consequences. **Spot checks** insert known-answer units at rate s; a device cheating on a fraction c of units survives n units with probability $(1-sc)^n$. **Strikes:** a failed check or an outvoted result adds a strike; three strikes ban the device. **Retroactive invalidation:** on a ban, every unit the device helped accept is invalidated and re-queued. **Adaptive replication** (Anderson, 2020): a device with $\ge T$ consecutive validated results may be accepted alone, except for a random audit fraction a (Algorithm 1).

Algorithm 1 Validator: quorum with strikes and retroactive invalidation (abbreviated)

Require: unit u, quorum q, trust threshold T, audit rate a, max replicas $R_{\max}$
$d_1 \leftarrow$ random eligible device
if streak$(d_1) \ge T$ **and** rand$() \ge a$ **then** accept $r(d_1)$; **return**
end if
repeat issue u to a new distinct device; on result r: $V[r] \leftarrow V[r] + 1$
until $\max_r V[r] \ge q$ **or** $R_{\max}$ replicas used
accept $r^\star \leftarrow \arg\max_r V[r]$
for all device d with result r_d **do**
    if $r_d = r^\star$ **then** streak(d) += 1; add u to contrib(d)
    else streak$(d) \leftarrow 0$; strikes(d) += 1
        if strikes$(d) \ge 3$ **then** ban d; re-queue all of contrib(d) ▷ retroactive
        end if
    end if
end for

Simulation. We simulated 2,000 devices and 10^5 units with honest error $e = 10^{-3}$, adversary fractions f from 0.01 to 0.20 and cheat probability $c \in \{1, 0.1\}$, with $T = 10$, $a = 0.10$ and $s = 0.05$. Table 7 gives the $f \in \{0.05, 0.20\}$ grid; the simulator and every run are in the repository. Without validation the wrong rate is about $f \cdot c + e$. With quorum, strikes and retroactive invalidation every colluder was banned and *no* wrong result remained among 10^5 units (an upper bound of 3×10^{-5} at 95% confidence); the penalties, not the larger quorum, do the work. Adaptive replication is cheaper at a small residual error. Honest devices were banned only when outvoted by colluders; rescinding strikes caused by later-banned devices would remove this (not yet tested).

Table 7: Validation policies under collusion (10^5 units, 2,000 devices, seed 1): wrong results accepted (after retroactive invalidation) / executions per accepted unit (every execution, including spot checks and re-runs). Quorum banned every cheater in every cell; adaptive replication banned 100% of always-cheaters and 67% and 66% of stealthy ones. Honest devices banned: at most 6 under quorum, none under adaptive.

	Always cheat ($c = 1$)		**Stealthy** ($c = 0.1$)	
Policy	$f = 0.05$	$f = 0.20$	$f = 0.05$	$f = 0.20$
No validation	5.08% / 1.00	20.14% / 1.00	0.61% / 1.00	2.09% / 1.00
Quorum q=2	0 / 2.01	0 / 2.03	0 / 2.06	0 / 2.22
Quorum q=3	0 / 3.01	0 / 3.03	0 / 3.09	0 / 3.30
Adaptive (q=2, spot 5%)	0.10% / 1.25	0.08% / 1.25	0.22% / 1.28	0.63% / 1.36

Credit and ledger. Credit (*Compute Credit*, in Work Units, WU) measures validated computation. Device d's credit is $C_d = \sum_{u \in \mathcal{V}_d} w_u$ over its validated units, where w_u is the unit's benchmark-normalised cost; a verified device that delivers no pack is credited from its verified rating, never a self-reported speed. Built today, each account's balance in Amazon DynamoDB holds an available amount and a lifetime total that never decreases; a device's pending credit is added when it reports or disconnects. A per-pack ledger keyed by pack and device, with clawbacks as reversing entries, is specified for the grid but not built. These credits are the PlanetComp points of the Executive Summary; credit can be transferred out as the PlanetComp token on the Solana blockchain at a published rate; users need no wallet unless they choose to transfer, and the operator can seal an epoch, writing the Merkle root of all balances on chain (built) so that anyone can check their own balance. Credit is to be redeemed one for one as processing time on the grid, $G_d = C_d - \sum_{j \in \mathcal{J}_d} w_j \geq 0$ (specified; the pool is free for now). Every check before a transfer, and the balance, live on the server.

Capacity check. One Durable Object per device sends a capacity test about once a minute: k small chunks of the device's own kernel with random seeds, sized for about a second. It times the answer on its own clock (network delay can only lower the measurement) and recomputes eight chunks chosen in secret (six on a GPU); faking a fraction g of the chunks is caught with probability about $1-(1-g)^8$ per test, and three failed tests in a row make the device unverified. A test costs about 1.7% of the time.

Commit, then random audit. The capacity check shows what a machine *can* do, not that its reported packs were computed. The program and the browser console therefore earn through *leases* checked after the fact. A verified device receives a random base and a number of CPU WorkPacks of 4×10^6 samples each, sized for about ten minutes; every pack's seed follows from the base, so anyone can recompute any pack. When time is up the device *commits* the Merkle root of its per-pack results; only then does the website choose $K = 20$ packs at random, and the device must answer within a minute with each result and its Merkle path, which the website recomputes. A device that computed a fraction h of its packs honestly passes with probability h^K: 12% at $h = 0.9$, 10^{-6} at $h = 0.5$. A pass credits every pack; a fail credits nothing and is a strike, and three strikes in a row hold the device for an hour. GPU leases commit a Merkle *sum* tree over dispatches of up to 8,192 groups, audited on 16 groups; they are tested against the CPU code, not yet on real WebGPU hardware. Every build reports its commit, and a website setting can flag or stop paying builds older than a minimum, never touching sign-in, balances or local use; a modified copy that hides its build is still credited only through these audits. Grid chat answers (Section 10) are credited per token, with a quarter of them double-checked.

7 Competitive Dispatch

Video and other latency-sensitive jobs need the *last* pack fast. PlanetCompute can therefore send every WorkPack to n machines at once, in the spirit of speculative backup tasks (Dean and Ghemawat, 2004), and turn the redundancy into a competition (Algorithm 2): (1) each pack goes to n devices (default $n = 5$) on n distinct networks (IPv4 /24 or IPv6 /48 prefixes, where possible distinct autonomous systems) and accounts; (2) a finisher sends the Merkle root ρ_d of its result (plus a perceptual hash for GPU frames) on its own authenticated socket, which timestamps the finish, and answers a challenge for one random leaf of that tree; no result or root is ever shown to a volunteer; (3) a result is accepted once $q = 3$ commitments from three networks match; (4) the first finisher in the accepted cluster receives αR (default $\alpha = \frac{1}{2}$) and every other matching finisher shares $(1-\alpha)R$ as consolation; (5) a non-matching result earns a strike, and three strikes ban the device and claw back what it helped accept. One Durable

Object per project coordinates its packs, so its message order is the authoritative finishing order, with no distributed locks or clock comparisons.

Lazy copiers. Because the hybrid rule keeps crediting matching answers after acceptance, it invites a *lazy copier*: a device that learns the accepted hash, from a colluder or from the consumer's side, and submits it without computing, to collect consolation credit (the lazy-participant problem of Golle and Mironov (2001)). Three rules close this: the dispatcher never shows a result, hash or root to any volunteer; credit follows the order in which roots arrive on each device's own socket, so a root cannot be replayed for another device; and the random-leaf challenge, answered within seconds, shows the device holds the whole result, not only its hash. A copier must therefore receive the entire result from a colluder, which is the "one computation, many submissions" Sybil case of Table 12, limited by network-distinct dispatch and account binding. A pack's credit is fixed at R, so copying never creates credit. The simulations did not model copiers.

Proposition 7.1 (Speed-race exposure)**.** *A fabricated answer costs nothing and arrives first. Without penalties, under first-q acceptance with n simultaneous replicas,* $P_{wrong} = \Pr[\mathrm{Bin}(n, f) \geq q] = \sum_{j=q}^{n} \binom{n}{j} f^j (1-f)^{n-j}$.

At $n = 5$, $q = 3$, $f = 0.2$ this is 5.8%; the simulation below measures 6.1%. For $n = 2q - 1$ it equals Equation (4): with $2q - 1$ replicas one of the two answers must reach q, so the race is the same event.

Algorithm 2 Competitive WorkPack dispatch with hybrid acceptance (abbreviated)

Require: WorkPack u, replicas n, quorum q, credit R, winner share α, deadline t_{dl}

send u at once to n devices on pairwise distinct networks and accounts
while now $< t_{\mathrm{dl}}$ **and** some device has not reported **do**
    receive Merkle root (d, ρ); challenge one random leaf; if the answer fails, STRIKE d; else add d to $V[\rho]$ ▷ or SSIM for GPU frames
    if nothing accepted **and** $|V[\rho]| \geq q$ **then** accept $h^\star \leftarrow \rho$; deliver to the consumer only ▷ low latency
    end if
end while
credit the earliest finisher in $V[h^\star]$ with αR, the others in $V[h^\star]$ $(1-\alpha)R$ shared
STRIKE every device that reported $\rho \neq h^\star$ ▷ as in Algorithm 1

Proposition 7.2 (Network diversity)**.** *If the adversary's devices lie on S networks and each pack uses n distinct networks, a pack holds at most* $\min(n, S)$ *adversarial replicas; hence if* $S < q$, $P_{wrong} = 0$.

This makes a data-centre attack expensive; proxies sell diversity, so penalties remain.

Matching AI outputs. CPU packs match by SHA-256. GPU inference is not bit-reproducible across vendors, so GPU outputs match when perceptually identical, by SSIM (Wang et al., 2004) against a threshold set per model. Table 8 shows why: exact matching would reject honest work, and one threshold is wrong, since 0.98 accepts both Stable Diffusion pairs but rejects both honest FLUX pairs, while a different picture scores 0.19–0.45. Provisional thresholds are about 0.90 for FLUX.1 schnell and 0.97 for Stable Diffusion 1.5, carried in each model edition's metadata.

Table 8: The same request on two machines (Linux + RTX 4090 vs Windows + Tesla T4): how alike the pictures are. Differences on the 0–255 scale; SSIM on grey levels, 7×7 window; from `scripts/compare_pictures.py`.

Picture (model, seed)	Pixels equal	Mean difference	Within 8 levels	SSIM
FLUX.1 schnell, cat (13)	4.3 %	4.07	81.8 %	0.940
FLUX.1 schnell, sign (14)	1.4 %	4.43	79.2 %	0.956
Stable Diffusion 1.5, lighthouse (1001)	9.6 %	1.17	98.3 %	0.987
Stable Diffusion 1.5, apple (1002)	5.8 %	1.61	97.3 %	0.992
Different pictures, same model (for contrast)				0.19–0.45

Simulation. We simulated 2,000 devices with log-normal speeds (median compute time 1.0), 5% honest drop-out and 10^{-3} honest error; colluders ($f = 0.2$, spread over 400 networks, the hardest case) answer instantly with a common fake. Each configuration processed 20,000 WorkPacks (Table 9). **(i)** The naive rule is exploitable as Proposition 7.1 predicts (6.09% wrong). **(ii)** Three-of-three unanimity re-issues mixed packs, so 1.80% are wrong and no colluder is out-voted; spare replicas ($n > q$) expose cheaters. **(iii)** With $n = 5$ and penalties every colluder was banned and no wrong pack survived, for all three acceptance rules. **(iv)** First-three-matching is fast (1.10) but credits the fastest quartile with 9.6× what the slowest receives; waiting for all is fair (2.7×) but slow (1.90); the **hybrid** rule, which accepts at the third match but keeps crediting later matching answers, is both (1.10, 2.7×). **(v)** With the adversary on two networks, wrong acceptance was zero in every configuration. The cost is about 5 executions per pack against 3.0–3.3 for sequential quorum with the same $q = 3$ (Table 7), so racing is for latency-sensitive jobs.

Table 9: Competitive dispatch, $f = 0.20$, $q = 3$, adversary on 400 networks. "Latency" is time to acceptance in units of the median device's compute time. "Fast/slow credit" is the mean credit of the fastest quartile of honest devices divided by that of the slowest quartile.

Dispatch	Acceptance	Penalties	Wrong accepted	Exec./pack	Latency	Fast/slow credit
$n = 3$	Unanimous (3 of 3)	✗	1.80%	6.67	1.64	1.7×
$n = 3$	Unanimous (3 of 3)	✓	1.80%	6.67	1.64	1.7×
$n = 5$	First 3 matching	✗	6.09%	5.19	1.22	4.2×
$n = 5$	First 3 matching	✓	0	5.03	1.10	9.6×
$n = 5$	Wait for all	✗	6.09%	5.19	1.79	2.3×
$n = 5$	Wait for all	✓	0	5.03	1.90	2.7×
$n = 5$	Hybrid (ours)	✗	6.09%	5.19	1.22	2.3×
$n = 5$	Hybrid (ours)	✓	0	5.03	1.10	2.7×

8 Orchestration at a Million Devices

The orchestrator connects consumers' jobs to volunteers' devices through Cloudflare Durable Objects (Cloudflare, 2026): single-threaded, strongly consistent objects with their own storage. It is designed and simulated, not yet deployed. Large data never passes through an object; inputs, outputs and weights move by presigned URLs. The simulation refined it into five kinds of object: **lane shards**, each holding the WebSockets of about 10^3 warm devices of one lane and running their capacity checks; sharded **lane directories**, each serving about 25 shards and knowing which jobs have packs waiting; a **planner** that moves devices between lanes every 15 s; a stateless **intake** Worker; and one **coordinator per job**.

Method. The objects' logic reads no clock and touches no network or storage, so a seeded discrete-event simulator (Node.js) runs the very classes that will be deployed, charging 0.5 ms per message plus 0.02 ms per batched item, 2–10 ms between objects and about 40 ms to a

device. Devices are 70% browser CPU, 25% browser WebGPU and 5% desktop GPUs (12 or 24 GB), with log-normal speeds and sessions (median 40 minutes); about three share a network address; 2% cheat (70% of their packs wrong) and 0.2% never answer. Five lanes (CPU, embeddings, an 8B LLM, SDXL, a 14B LLM) receive log-normal jobs (median 2,000 device-seconds) at half of capacity. 80% of honest devices start with an earned reputation and cheaters start untrusted; new devices are never trusted alone; trusted ones are audited at 5% or more; late packs are hedged; a caught cheater is banned and its recent packs re-run. *Push* spreads packs over shards at start, *steal* lets empty shards take half the busiest queue, and *pull* lets shards with idle devices ask for batches.

Table 10: Orchestrator simulation, one simulated hour each. "Idle while queued" is device time spent idle while packs for the same lane waited, in the worst lane. Times are time to finish, at the 99th percentile, for small ($< 10^3$ device-seconds) and large ($\geq 3 \times 10^4$) jobs. All runs use pull unless named otherwise, with 10^4 consumers, and precede the fixes described below; the million-device run with the fixes is described in the text.

Scenario	**Devices online**	**Idle while queued**	**Stalled jobs**	**Small p99 (s)**	**Large p99 (s)**
Pull, 10^6 volunteers (first run, before the fixes)	916,831	0.26%	0	144	417
Pull, 10^5 volunteers (baseline)	91,563	0.22%	1	149	513
Push	91,646	**32.9%**	**4,466**	857	1,660
Steal	91,667	1.47%	0	151	534
Deploy at 30 min, 30-s reconnect jitter	90,973	0.51%	0	150	488
30% of devices lost at once	88,084	0.55%	0	151	464
Burst: 2,000 jobs of 5×10^4 device-s	91,261	0.41%	23	154	684
Only 40 network addresses	91,632	0.32%	0	147	496
Demand at 90% of capacity	91,855	0.01%	**6,319**	1,869	2,623

Results and faults found. Push grid-locked: a third of device time was wasted because packs sat in shards whose devices had left; stealing repaired most of this and pull removed it (Table 10). The simulator found seven faults before any deployment (listed in the repository), among them a single directory per lane that was 67% busy at 10^5 devices (now sharded), 95% of pull requests coming back empty, a livelock of about 2,500 requests a second, and about 11,600 multi-gigabyte model downloads an hour (moves now prefer devices that hold the model). Three later fixes: *sleeper cheaters*, which earn trust and then cheat, had 5,278 wrong answers accepted in an hour at 10^5 devices; with audits that fall with a device's record but never below 5%, and re-running a caught device's last 256 packs, accepted wrong answers fell to 2,031, of which 1,947 were corrected after delivery and 84 never were (all from sleepers not yet caught when the hour ended); a further 2,049 were fixed before delivery. Admission now refuses a job whose estimated wait exceeds five minutes (burst stalls fell from 23 to 3, while refused submissions rose from 2,815 to 7,975), and spare copies are cancelled on acceptance. Still open: under 90% demand, 4,633 admitted jobs still stalled (from 6,319).

Faults in the platform. With 1% of requests between objects refused, 0.2% of WebSocket messages lost, 0.5 crashes per object per hour and 0.2% of replies lost after delivery, three designs were compared at 20,000 devices for one hour. With nothing retried, 4,360 of 6,573 jobs finished, 493 were lost and 10,202 units went uncredited; retries without message IDs finished 6,167 of 6,584, lost 113, processed 6,095 items twice and paid 1,123 units twice; the simple design finished 6,426 of 6,637, lost none and credited all 1,051,195 units exactly once. It needs no queue service and no load balancer, only four rules: keep a message until acknowledged and resend with growing pauses; give every message an ID and drop repeats; save state before acknowledging; re-issue a long-overdue copy.

One million devices, and the cost. In one simulated hour with the fixes above, at about a million devices (1,151,633 came and went, 917,629 online on average) and 10^4 consumers, 253,881 of 261,125 jobs finished within the hour and the rest were still running; none was refused or stalled; 186,057 cheating answers were caught and none was delivered uncorrected; and the busiest of 42 lane directories peaked at 411 messages a second. This run had the 2% ordinary cheaters of the Method; sleeper cheaters were tested only at 10^5 devices (above), where 84 wrong answers remained. It is a single run with one seed.

The cost. The cost runs of Table 11 were separate (same seed), so their job counts differ slightly. At list prices, the original design's running cost comes mostly from about 8,700 objects that stay awake, about four messages between objects per WorkPack, and a ledger write per credited device per minute (Table 11); volunteers' status reports sent to the website each minute, as first built, cost 1.75 times as much as reports on the open WebSocket every five minutes. A **low-cost design** changes five things, each a simulator switch: the ledger rolled up hourly, job groups instead of one object per job, shards of 10^4 devices, batching of messages between objects within 250 ms, and multi-pack leases for trusted devices. Its first million-device run delivered 4 wrong results uncorrected, because cheaters holding leases filled packs up to the copy limit, then accepted without enough matching answers; never accepting a pack without them, and leasing to trusted devices only, fixed it. The fixed design costs 11.4 times less than the original with the same status reports; the price is latency (small jobs finish in a median of 226 s instead of 74 s) and idle capacity: in the CPU lane devices sat idle while packs waited 33% of the time (the original design: under 0.3%), because leases and batching hold work in a few places, as push did. It suits batch work; the idle lane is the next fault to fix.

Table 11: One simulated hour at about a million volunteer devices and 10^4 consumers (demand at half of capacity), at list prices. Same seed in all three runs, which are separate from the run described in the text.

	Original design	**Low-cost, first run**	**Low-cost, with the fix**
Running cost relative to the original (reports every 5 min)	1	1/11.4	1/11.4
Objects awake on average	8,743	213	214
Requests between objects per second (billed)	49,458	11,135	11,483
Device messages per second	20,432	5,984	6,962
Ledger writes per second	14,686	683	579
Jobs submitted / finished within the hour	261,385 / 254,027	261,491 / 230,708	261,681 / 236,650
Jobs refused / stalled (> 600 s)	0 / 0	0 / 281	0 / 76
Small jobs: time to finish, median / 99th pct.	74 / 152 s	249 / 767 s	226 / 599 s
First result to the consumer, median / 99th pct.	7 / 21 s	58 / 262 s	51 / 210 s
Extra copies (quorum, audits, hedges)	22.5%	40.3%	30.7%
Accepted without enough matching answers	0	680	0
Wrong answers delivered and never corrected	0	4	0

What it does not show, and what is next. Cloudflare's real latency, model speeds, browsers and programs are not measured; behaviour and cheating are modelled. The next steps are E9 in Table 17. After an update clients must reconnect with random delay: 10^5 simulated devices reconnected at about 9×10^4 a second without it, about 3×10^3 with 30 s of jitter. The logic is not tied to Cloudflare: five small interfaces (actor runtime, object store, database, mailer, secrets) can be provided by plain servers with a load balancer and a message queue.

9 Threat Model and Privacy

Table 12 lists the main threats. The Coinhive lesson (Eskandari et al., 2018; Konoth et al., 2018) is that background compute was condemned for being *covert*; PlanetCompute computes only with recorded consent and always shows what runs (Section 9.1).

Table 12: Threats and mitigations.

Threat	**Mitigation**
Malicious job or hostile model file	No-import WASM in the browser; WebGPU shader validation; desktop engines in their own processes in the OS sandbox (models read-only, no network, no other programs, no sign-in)
Tampered module or update	Every build signed with Ed25519, with a key kept off the website, storage and build service; the servers' update agent installs only builds whose signature checks (the desktop program does not update itself); third-party modules checked by SHA-256 against a signed manifest: specified; installers to be code-signed
Stolen sign-in	No passwords (one-time codes by email); email on a sign-in from a new browser or country; list of sign-ins with sign-out; a computer's link bound to its device key
Leaked keys; exposed prompts	Keys held as encrypted secrets of the website, with rotation; no prompt written into shared files
Free file storage	Only files the account's program made (SHA-512 registry), only PNG/WebM at the program's sizes, daily limits per account and network
Lazy copier (submits another's answer)	Results never shown to volunteers, roots bound to each device's socket, a random Merkle-leaf challenge, fixed credit per pack (Section 7)
Cheating volunteer, fast fakes	Built: commit-then-random-audit, Freivalds checks, repeated prompts, strikes and bans. Simulated: quorum, spare replicas $n > q$, network-distinct quorum, retroactive invalidation and clawback (Sections 6, 7)
Sybil devices; one computation, many submissions	Account-bound device keys, rate limits on new accounts; per-account replica exclusion (specified) (a group that computes once returns a correct result but defeats independence)
Old or modified program keeps earning	Credit and transfer checks only on the server; builds with an identity credited by audits only; a minimum build for earning (Section 6)
Data exposure to volunteers	Privacy tiers (specified): *Public* (any host; the data is visible, so only non-confidential jobs), *Protected* (desktop only; rotated fragments in memory, not encryption during processing), *Confidential* (attested server TEEs or FHE; at higher cost)
Perceived cryptojacking; antivirus	Explicit opt-in, visible indicator, one-click pause, open-source client, no silent auto-start, conservative default caps; code signing and vendor allow-list submissions planned

What volunteers can see. A volunteer's machine sees the data it computes on. Homomorphic encryption is orders of magnitude too slow for neural networks, multi-party computation needs round trips per layer, and attested GPU enclaves exist only on servers. PlanetCompute therefore offers *rotation obfuscation*: for secret orthogonal Q, R, $x' = Rx$ and $W' = QWR^\top$ give $W'x' = Q(Wx)$, and in transformers the rotation can be folded into all weights in advance at no run-time cost (Ashkboos et al., 2024a,b). A longer key does not help against a public model: orthogonal Procrustes recovers R from the published and rotated embeddings in one SVD. What helps is private weights, consumer-side decoders, and a small blast radius: G key groups, keys changed every period T_k, and fragments only, so one broken key exposes fragments of about 1% of one lane for one day with $G = 100$. Every job is to declare a privacy tier (Table 12; specified, not built). Protected is not a confidentiality guarantee: a determined expert with the public model could decode one key's share of a Protected job.

9.1 Consent, Cost and Safety for Volunteers

What the volunteer sees. Nothing runs until the volunteer ticks a consent box, which names the shared cores, caps, status reports and that electricity and wear are the volunteer's, and presses *Start computing*; a new session needs new consent. With the console closed, a status light (Running, Idle, Paused, Stopped) with PlanetCompute's own CPU, GPU and memory use and the credit received stays in the page header; *Pause* keeps the session. The program shows the same console in a window and keeps a tray icon. Used today are consent, cores and the CPU cap, and (desktop only, from the tray) running when the window is closed. Specified are user idle, AC power, allowed hours, a thermal limit and other programs' load: the desktop reads them from the operating system (temperatures where sensors exist), the browser only partly, through Chromium's Idle Detection, Battery Status and Compute Pressure APIs, and not at all for temperature.

What it costs the volunteer. The marginal cost is electricity, $\Delta P \cdot h$ for extra draw ΔP over h hours (Table 13; assumed values, to be measured, E6 in Table 17). Electricity and wear are the volunteer's: the terms, the consent text, the program's agreement box and `-help` all say that these costs, including wear of fans, batteries, processors and graphics cards, are not reimbursed and that PlanetCompute.ai is not liable for them. PlanetCompute is not a source of income; a volunteer's electricity buys credit to be redeemed as processing time on the grid. Every model licence in the library allows redistribution from PlanetCompute's own storage, with conditions (Table 13); non-commercial models are not added.

Table 13: Left: illustrative extra electricity in one 8-hour night. Right: licences of the library's models (a reading of the licences, to be confirmed by counsel before launch).

Device	ΔP	Energy
Laptop CPU, all cores	25 W	0.20 kWh
Desktop CPU, all cores	80 W	0.64 kWh
Desktop discrete GPU	200 W	1.60 kWh

Licence	Library models; conditions
Apache-2.0	Qwen, FLUX.1 schnell, Z-Image Turbo, Wan 2.1, T5/umt5; ship licence, mark changes
OpenRAIL-M	Stable Diffusion 1.5; pass on its use restrictions
MIT	CLIP-L, DeepSeek-R1 distillation; keep notice
Llama 3.3 Community	DeepSeek-R1-Distill-Llama-70B; "Built with Llama", Meta's use policy
Non-commercial	none (e.g. FLUX.1 dev): not added

10 One Program for Both Sides: `planetCompute`

`planetCompute` is one Rust and Tauri 2 (Tauri Programme within The Commons Conservancy, 2024) program with llama.cpp (Gerganov and llama.cpp contributors, 2023) linked in. It **contributes** when idle (on a desktop it shows the same volunteer console as the website; on a server, `-headless` runs a native engine that computes the same CPU WorkPacks, checked against shared test vectors on every build) and **harnesses** when its owner needs answers: a local OpenAI-style API (`/v1/chat/completions`, `/v1/images/generations`) for chat with llama.cpp and for pictures and video with stable-diffusion.cpp (leejet and contributors, 2026), run as a separate process. Every library model file is checked by SHA-256, so devices running one model ID run the same bytes. Jobs run on this computer, or in the PlanetCompute pool, supplied by contributors' programs and, for now, by the operator's in-house SherpaHubs.

Grid, step one. A chat job sent to `POST /v1/jobs` goes to an idle volunteer program that holds the model; it runs at temperature 0 with a seed chosen by the website, and with probability 0.25 a second program runs it too and the answers must match exactly. A live load test first saw answers take 36.8 s (median) as llama.cpp used every thread of a loaded server; limiting grid jobs to the shared cores fixed it (Table 14).

A sandboxed native engine. A job carries a model ID and inputs, never code, but a model file could exploit a parser bug. The program therefore never opens a model itself: a separate *model engine* and the image engine run in the operating system's sandbox (Landlock and seccomp on Linux, a sandbox profile on macOS, an AppContainer in a one-process job on Windows), may read only the models and their own folder, write only the pictures folder (the model engine writes nothing), and have no network, no other programs and no sign-in. `-sandbox-check` makes each engine try to read, list or write outside its folders, connect to the internet and start a shell; every attempt must fail, on all five CI builds.

First measurements. Table 14 collects the program's measurements. On a rented RTX A4000 the first token arrived after 0.10 s and library downloads ran at 17–18 MB/s. Pictures and video ran on an RTX 4090 under Linux and on a Tesla T4 under Windows (`planetCompute.exe`). All ten RTX 4090 jobs ran on the GPU at 68–100% use with no CPU fallback; the T4 took 2.9–4.2 times as long for pictures and 6 times as long for the clip; on the T4 machine's processor the CPU build made a 256×256, 4-step picture in 62.9 s. On a GitHub macOS runner Metal fails and the CPU took 46 s.

Table 14: Measured on real machines: the same program on rented servers and the operator's live server. Pictures and video through the Harness API (Vulkan builds); the first job of each model includes loading it, "then" is every later job; GPU memory as used on the RTX 4090.

Chat, RTX A4000 (16 GB), 4-bit, all layers on the GPU in the Vulkan build: tokens/s	**Vulkan build**	**CPU build**
Qwen3 4B Instruct	83.1	23.6 (3.5×)
Qwen2.5-Coder 7B	58.9	17.4 (3.4×)
Pictures and video: seconds	**RTX 4090, Linux**	**Tesla T4, Windows**
FLUX.1 schnell 4-bit, 1024×1024 / 1024×768, 4 steps (12–14 GB)	38.7, then 9.4–12.0	111.4, then 36.8
Stable Diffusion 1.5 8-bit, 512×512, 20 steps (4 GB)	21.2, then 4.4–4.5	89.8, then 15.9
Wan 2.1 T2V 1.3B 8-bit, 2 s clip, 832×480, 33 frames, 20 steps (10 GB)	87.8 and 77.2	492.5
Grid jobs, five scripts to two program copies (four shared cores each, Qwen2.5 0.5B, 4-bit)	**Every core**	**Shared cores**
Run time of an answer, median (slowest)	36.8 s	0.8 (1.9) s
Eight hours side by side, 30 October 2026, 07:45–15:42 UTC (chat jobs, qwen2.5-0.5b)	**5 load scripts**	**1 SherpaHub**
Chat jobs sent (an hour)	5,769 (730)	4,384 (555; set 600)
Answered	99.9%	99.8%
Time to answer, median / 95th percentile	3.2 / 25 s	3.5 / 41 s
Computers that answered	the same 5	the same 5

10.1 Tests

Every test is written up step by step in `docs/TESTING.md`; Table 15 lists the main ones.

Table 15: Main automated and live tests (automated unless stated).

What	Where	Result
Harness and engine sandbox	CI builds	Harness 23 of 23 on Windows, macOS and Linux (download, hash, question, streamed answer); sandbox: 8 checks per engine, on all five builds
WorkPacks: kernels, broker, audits	EPYC server, Workers runtime, headless browser, test database	Kernels: program 7 of 7, format 4 of 4, browser 33 of 33 (same hashes over 200 shapes), `-workpack-check` on every build; broker 29 of 29, device code 7 of 7, end to end 8 of 8 (liars banned), prompt batches 20 of 20; commit and random audit 23 of 23
Grid jobs; minimum build	website, program; live	Grid 22 of 22 (live in Table 14); old builds credited, flagged or unpaid by mode: 17 of 17
Signed builds	the server agent	7 of 7: another build, one changed bit, another key or an empty signature fail; RFC 8032 vector

11 Related Work

Table 16: PlanetCompute versus related systems, from public descriptions. ✓ present, ✗ absent, ∼ partial or historical; for PlanetCompute, ∼ means designed (and, where stated, simulated) but not yet deployed.

System	Zero-install	Native overnight	Same results, both hosts	No native job code	GPU	Frame-par. AI packs	Race + consolation	Network-distinct q.	Validated credit	Consent by design
BOINC (Anderson, 2020)	✗	✓	✗	✗	✓	∼	✗	∼	✓	✓
Folding@home (Beberg et al., 2009)	∼	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	∼	✗	∼	✓
Gridcoin (Gridcoin contributors, 2026)	✗	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓
Golem (Golem Factory, 2016)	✗	✓	✗	∼	✓	∼	✗	✗	∼	✓
Salad (Salad Technologies, 2026)	✗	✓	✗	∼	✓	∼	✗	✗	∼	✓
Petals (Borzunov et al., 2023)	✗	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Pando (Lavoie et al., 2019)	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Gray computing (Pan et al., 2015)	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	∼
Coinhive (2017–19)	✓	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
PlanetCompute	✓	✓	✓	✓	∼	∼	∼	∼	✓	✓

BOINC (Anderson, 2004, 2020), the closest prior work (Table 16) and the source of PlanetCompute's validation vocabulary, ships native executables per platform with its account's privileges, has no browser host, and can require distinct users or hosts per quorum, not distinct networks. Gray computing (Pan et al., 2015) and Pando (Lavoie et al., 2019) computed in browsers with JavaScript, and WebAssembly remains slower than native code (Jangda et al., 2019); Golem (Golem Factory, 2016) and Salad (Salad Technologies, 2026) sell consumer compute through VMs or containers; Petals (Borzunov et al., 2023) and Ryabinin and Gusev (2020) serve or train large models across peers. Backup tasks (Dean and Ghemawat, 2004) and split-frame rendering have precedents; no surveyed system combines these ideas for AI inference on untrusted consumer machines.

12 Open Challenges and Known Gaps

Table 17 gives the status of every hypothesis and experiment; five wider challenges remain. (1) **Demand:** the grid suits only parallel, small-input, deadline-tolerant, non-confidential jobs. (2) **Mobile:** iOS forbids long background compute. (3) **Sybil resistance** beyond account binding without intrusive identity checks. (4) **GPU determinism:** tolerances must be re-measured in each runtime and for AMD, Intel, Apple and other NVIDIA GPUs. (5) **Not yet built**, beyond Table 17: a live rerun of the split job with several packs in flight (built and simulated, not yet run live), stage 4 maths packs, SherpaHubs on volunteers' computers, GPU leases on real WebGPU hardware, and strikes for programs whose grid answers disagree. Windows and Mac downloads are not yet code-signed, and the native contributor runs CPU WorkPacks only.

Table 17: Built today, specified but not built, and open: hypotheses, planned experiments and the path from simulation to a real test, with status on 31 October 2026.

	Built today	**Specified, not built**
Jobs	Credit WorkPacks (Monte Carlo); int8 maths packs (Split); whole prompts for chat, pictures, video (desktop)	Any third-party module, by SHA-256 against a signed manifest
Kernels	Fixed WebAssembly SIMD or JavaScript, native SSE2 or NEON; integer, bit-identical, tested on every build	The byte ABI (`pc_alloc`, `pc_run`, `pc_output`; no imports), determinism profile
Transport	Leases on each device's capacity-check socket; the SherpaHub broker's binary pack messages	`POST /v1/claim` and `POST /v1/units/{id}/result`
Checking	Commit-then-random-audit; Freivalds on every maths pack; a share of prompts repeated elsewhere	Network-distinct quorum and race for every unit (simulated, Sections 6, 7)
GPU	Browser WebGPU WorkPacks (tested on the CPU, not yet on a real GPU); the desktop's AI engines	Desktop GPU WorkPacks through wgpu
	Hypothesis or test	**Status**
H1	Browser WebAssembly reaches half of native throughput on the CPU kernels	int8 maths kernel as WebAssembly in Node.js on one AMD EPYC core: 24.7 against 57.9 billion operations/s (0.43): not met on one core; browsers not yet measured
H2, H3	Background tabs lose over half their throughput, the tray program nothing; at $\gamma = 0.2$ the foreground slows below 5%	Open
H4	The two hosts give bit-identical results	Met for the built-in kernels (every build); third-party modules wait for the byte ABI
H5	Browser WebGPU is within 30% of native wgpu	Waits for desktop GPU WorkPacks (planned)
H6	Frame-parallel packs cut time to video 10× with 50 machines	Open (Figure 2 is a design)
H7	Frames from different GPUs match at SSIM ≥ 0.98	Partly: NVIDIA types 0.986–0.998 (SDXL); RTX 4090 vs T4 0.987–0.992 (SD 1.5), 0.940–0.956 (FLUX)
E4, E8	Validation and the race, live, with injected cheaters	Simulated (Tables 7, 9); live runs open
E6	Energy per validated unit per host (RAPL, powermetrics)	Open; Table 13 is assumed
E9	Orchestrator: (1) simulation; (2) Durable Objects with up to 10^6 generated devices and 5,000–20,000 real WebSockets; (3) real programs; (4) soft launch	(1) done (Tables 10–11); (2)–(4) next

13 Conclusion

PlanetCompute is designed to turn idle consumer machines into one AI inference grid, with credit redeemable as processing time; so far its grid has run only on the operator's servers. It cuts the work, not the model; specifies GPU audits costing a few percent offline; lets browsers with no model compute exactly checked maths packs; shows in simulation that racing with spare replicas, network-distinct quorums and clawback is safe, fast and fair; and, at a million simulated devices, delivered no uncorrected wrong answer in the final designs. Live tests with volunteers, the audits in the program and the experiments of Table 17 come next; the code, scripts and raw results behind every number are public at https://github.com/syncaissa/planetCompute.cpp.

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